BUYPAK: Building a Pakistan-First Online Store

By Zain Ul Hassan

Online shopping in Pakistan has its own habits. Many customers prefer to pay when the parcel arrives, they want to track it with a local courier, and they care that a phone or laptop is genuine and comes with a warranty. **BUYPAK** is an online store built around those habits, under the promise "Shop More | Pay Less".

What shoppers get

The storefront covers the full journey from browsing to delivery.

- **Easy discovery:** the home page has a hero banner, a product slider, deals, new arrivals, photo-based category and brand tiles, and promotional banners. Search shows results as you type and remembers your history, which you can delete.
- **Rich product pages:** colour and storage variants, photo galleries, product video, stock status, recently viewed items and share buttons.
- **Cash on Delivery checkout:** the default way to pay, with optional online payments through JazzCash and Safepay.
- **Customer accounts:** saved addresses, order history, a wishlist that syncs when signed in, and a track-order page.
- **Returns and reviews:** customers can request a return and leave reviews.

A control panel for the owner

A store is only useful if the owner can run it without touching code. BUYPAK ships with an admin panel for the day-to-day work:

- Products, categories (with an optional photo), coupons and popups
- Orders with print-ready sheets, payments, courier shipments and returns
- Customers, messages, reviews and audience lists
- Editable home page content, store settings and reports
- Bulk product import from CSV, an audit log of admin actions and data backup

Built for phones first

Most Pakistani shoppers browse on their phones, so the layout is designed for small screens first and scales up to desktops. Photos are resized for each device and load lazily, pages are cached and refreshed at most every minute, and changes saved in the admin appear straight away. In the latest pass, icon-only tiles were replaced with real product photography, with icons kept only as a fallback if an image fails to load.

Security

The store handles customer details and orders, so security was part of the build from the start.

- The admin area sits behind a signed session, and production refuses to run with a weak or default admin password.
- Strict security headers and a Content-Security-Policy are set on every page.
- Inputs are validated with Zod, and sensitive areas such as admin, cart and checkout are hidden from search engines.
- Sign-in and form endpoints are rate limited.

Tech stack

Area	Tools
Framework	Next.js 15 (App Router), React 19
Language	TypeScript (strict)
Styling	Tailwind CSS
Validation	Zod
Data	Supabase in production, with a local JSON file for development
Payments	Cash on Delivery, with optional JazzCash and Safepay

What I learned

Building BUYPAK taught me that a store is more than a product grid. Delivery tracking, returns, stock handling and a simple admin panel are what make it usable for a real owner. Designing for the local payment habit of Cash on Delivery also shaped the checkout from the start.

What's next

The roadmap includes more payment options, wider courier coverage and a growing catalog across mobiles, laptops, electronics, fashion and home essentials.

Live site: add your link here · Source code: add your repository link here